

THE SHOPS AT COLUMBUS CIRCLE

DATE: March 6th, 2024

PREPARED FOR: The Charles Group

PREPARED BY: The Shops at Columbus Circle, Deutsche Bank Center

RE: Request For Proposal - Confidential
The Shops at Columbus Circle
Social Media Strategy, Content & Management Agency

Positioning Statement

The Shops at Columbus Circle is a dazzling mixed-use shopping, dining, and entertainment destination that has transformed the Upper West Side and Midtown areas, serving as the beating heart of the neighborhood. The central location of The Shops at Columbus Circle connects the entertainment energy of Times Square, the cultural activities of Lincoln Center, the recreational spirit of Central Park, the hotel district of Central Park South, and the residential neighborhoods of the Upper West Side. In its 20th year, The Shops at Columbus Circle has continued to keep the community connected and engaged through impactful partnerships with local community and cultural institutions via onsite events, activations, and meaningful cross-marketing efforts. With over 40 premier retail shops, two Michelin 3-Starred restaurants, Whole Foods Market, Mandarin Oriental Hotel New York and Spa, Jazz at Lincoln Center, and Equinox Fitness Club, The Shops at Columbus Circle is an iconic destination serving local New Yorkers and tourists through elevated and unique experiences.

Overarching Marketing Goals and Objectives

- Connect The Shops at Columbus Circle to the Upper West Side neighborhood through campaign creative and messaging
- Educate audience about The Shops at Columbus Circle through campaign creative supported by specific programs and tactics
- Create targeted, highly personalized approach to content and media channels
- Grow digital databases – social media, website, and eblast
- Drive awareness and conversion
- Own positioning of The Shops at Columbus Circle as the beating heart of the Upper West Side

Social Media Scope of Work

The Agency's scope of work would include the planning and implementation of:

- **Social Media Strategy, Execution and Management:**
 - o Develop social media strategy (Instagram & Facebook) that aligns with overall TSACC marketing vision and audience.
 - o Rebrand existing social media channels.
 - o Launch TikTok channel.
 - o Responsible for creating and managing monthly social media calendar in partnership with TSACC marketing team.
 - o Strategize and create content unique and authentic to our destination, neighborhood, social media audience and current & potential customers.
 - o Create and manage strategic paid influencer/content creator plan.
 - o Leverage Agency's influencer/content creator network to increase User Generated Content and create authentic, loyal UGC network specific to TSACC.

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- Work in a holistic manner with the public relations strategy to amplify 20th Anniversary storytelling and positioning of TSACC as the “beating heart of the Upper West Side”.
- Focus on supporting key retailers and restaurants to increase conversion, amplify onsite events and activations, increase foot traffic, and support marketing campaigns.
- Promote awareness, generate buzz, and create micro-campaigns around new retailer and restaurant openings.
- Work with our retailers, restaurants, stakeholders (Jazz at Lincoln Center, Mandarin Oriental NY) and local community partners and constituents for content captures and calendar integration.
- Work with program partners and 3rd party partners for content grabs and social media promotion/amplification (events, activations, etc.)
- Create fresh and socially relevant content themes & campaigns around social media trends.
- Increase metrics and engagement on all platforms growing the audience (size and demographic), reach and community impact.
- Generate onsite traffic and website leads via Instagram and Facebook platforms.
- Provide annual, monthly and campaign specific reports for social media reflecting current status, results, metrics, benchmarks, and personal achievements.
- Increase brand awareness (followers and shares), while converting existing customers into social media advocates through engagement (comments, likes, mentions, tags, etc.)
- Manage community engagement.
- Coordinate weekly onsite content grabs.

Request for Proposal:

The following deliverables are to be submitted as the Agency proposal.

1. **Conceptualization** – Agency to provide a sample content calendar specific to TSACC inclusive of images/video, copy & hashtags for each channel.
2. **Case Studies** – 3 case studies that demonstrate Agency's experience and capability given the property and outlined scope of work. Please provide examples of social media content creation and management for past/current clients representative of 30 days of content.
3. **Identification of Opportunities & Challenges**
4. **Personnel/Management** – Identify the account manager that will oversee all aspects of the scope of work. Also, identify the team members responsible for conducting the day-to-day work on behalf of TSACC– including an organizational chart, experience, biographies and length of time with Agency.
5. **Fee Structure** – Inclusive of monthly retainer and all additional elements that incur costs for year one, including fixed pricing, billable hourly rates, subcontractor fees and markup rates.
6. **Client References** – 3 client references are requested with your submission including contact name, address, phone number and email.
7. **Conflicts of Interest** – Agency to certify they have no conflicts of interest in serving TSACC.

Proposal Overview

Agencies should strive to apply fresh, strategic thinking to their proposal, and should come to the table armed with an overview of prospective partners, strategies and event activation concepts for in-depth discussion. Agencies should be prepared to discuss their approach from conception to execution.

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Intent to Bid	Friday, March 8 th , 2024
Submit Proposal	Friday, April 5 th , 2024
Presentations	Monday, April 8 th – Wednesday, April 10 th , 2024
Finalist Presentation/Interviews (if needed)	Thursday, April 11 th - Friday, April 12 th , 2024
Agency Selection/Contract Awarded By	Friday, April 19 th , 2024

Proposal Submission Procedure:

1. Agency provides notice of intent to bid via email to aleopold@related.com by Friday, March 8th, 2024.
2. Both parties will sign an NDA (non-disclosure agreement).
3. Comprehension of RFP
 - a. Agency is responsible for understanding the requirements, objectives, and scope of work under the RFP, or will inquire to attain this knowledge.

Proposal Evaluation Criteria:

1. **Overall Agency Experience** – including the history of the company, professional experience and clients relevant to the RFP. Experience specific to retail, fashion, shopping centers, chefs & restaurants, hospitality, and public spaces.
2. **Scope of Work:** Assessment of proposed strategies, creativity, and detail of plan
3. **Qualifications of Personnel:** Experienced and eager New York City based team with experience and qualifications relating to the RFP.
4. **Capabilities:** Evaluation of past projects, clients, case studies, references, etc. to demonstrate the Agency will be able to deliver
5. **Cost Effectiveness:** Assessment of whether the proposed budget and services are aligned with the overall value of the project.

Agency Selection:

We will award this bid to the agency that best demonstrates their ability to exceed the needs and expectations we have laid out. We do not anticipate a second round of presentations.

The proposal can be emailed to:

- Stephanie Fink-Plakoudas, Senior Vice President, Related Companies: splakoudas@related.com
- Adelaide Farrell, Marketing Manager, Related Companies: afarrell@related.com
- Alexa Leopold, Marketing Coordinator, Related Companies: aleopold@related.com